

2026

Social & Modern Studies

Grade 9 NCE — **Paper 1 of 4**

Focus: Governance & Democracy • Globalisation

Duration: 2 hours **Total Marks:** 100

Candidate Name: _____

Class / Form: _____ Index No.: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. This paper has **four sections**: A, B, C, and D.
2. Answer **ALL** questions in Sections A, B, and D.
3. In Section C, answer **ALL THREE** structured questions.
4. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
5. For Section A, tick (✓) **ONE** box only per question.
6. Use blue or black ink. Pencil may be used for diagrams only.
7. The marks for each question are shown in brackets [].
8. Calculators are **NOT** permitted.

Section	A — MCQ	B — Source	C — Structured	D — Essay	Total
Maximum marks	20	30	30	20	100
Marks scored					

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions [20 marks — 1 mark each] Tick ONE box only per question.

1. The supreme law of Mauritius is contained in its: [1]
- ☐ A Penal Code
 - ☐ B Constitution
 - ☐ C Civil Code
 - ☐ D Electoral Act
2. Mauritius gained independence from Britain in which year? [1]
- ☐ A 1965
 - ☐ B 1966
 - ☐ C 1968
 - ☐ D 1970
3. The head of government in Mauritius is the: [1]
- ☐ A President
 - ☐ B Speaker of the National Assembly
 - ☐ C Prime Minister
 - ☐ D Chief Justice
4. How often are general elections held in Mauritius? [1]
- ☐ A Every 3 years
 - ☐ B Every 4 years
 - ☐ C Every 5 years
 - ☐ D Every 6 years
5. The Best Loser System in Mauritius is designed to: [1]
- ☐ A Reward candidates who narrowly missed winning a seat
 - ☐ B Ensure proportional communal representation in the National Assembly
 - ☐ C Increase voter turnout in rural constituencies
 - ☐ D Reduce the cost of holding general elections
6. Universal suffrage means that: [1]
- ☐ A All citizens receive free education
 - ☐ B Every adult citizen has the right to vote

- ☐ C Only educated citizens may vote
- ☐ D Voting is compulsory for all citizens

7. The separation of powers divides government into which three branches?

[1]

- ☐ A National, regional, and local government
- ☐ B Public, private, and non-governmental sectors
- ☐ C Executive, legislative, and judicial branches
- ☐ D Central, federal, and state governments

8. Which of the following is a primary function of the judiciary in Mauritius?

[1]

- ☐ A Making and passing new laws
- ☐ B Implementing government policies
- ☐ C Interpreting and applying the law
- ☐ D Collecting taxes from citizens

9. Which of the following is a fundamental right guaranteed by the Mauritian Constitution?

[1]

- ☐ A Right to free housing provided by the state
- ☐ B Freedom of expression and conscience
- ☐ C Right to guaranteed employment
- ☐ D Right to an annual salary increase

10. The Rule of Law means that:

[1]

- ☐ A Only the ruling party is above the law
- ☐ B Laws apply only to ordinary citizens
- ☐ C Every person and institution is subject to and accountable under the law
- ☐ D Courts may change the law as they see fit

11. Globalisation is best described as:

[1]

- ☐ A The military expansion of powerful nations
- ☐ B Increased trade only between neighbouring countries
- ☐ C The growing interconnection of economies, cultures, and societies worldwide
- ☐ D The removal of all national governments

12. The World Trade Organization (WTO) primarily aims to:

[1]

- ☐ A Promote military alliances between member states

- ☐ B Regulate international trade and resolve trade disputes
- ☐ C Provide emergency loans to countries in financial crisis
- ☐ D Manage global population growth

13. Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) refers to:

[1]

- ☐ A Government spending on foreign aid programmes
- ☐ B Investment by a company in one country into business interests in another country
- ☐ C Loans provided by the World Bank to developing nations
- ☐ D Trading in foreign currencies on international markets

14. A Transnational Corporation (TNC) is a company that:

[1]

- ☐ A Trades exclusively with neighbouring countries
- ☐ B Is jointly owned by two or more national governments
- ☐ C Operates in more than one country
- ☐ D Employs only workers from foreign countries

15. Trade liberalisation involves:

[1]

- ☐ A Increasing tariffs and import quotas to protect local industries
- ☐ B Reducing barriers such as tariffs and quotas to encourage free trade
- ☐ C Banning foreign companies from operating in a country
- ☐ D Controlling foreign exchange rates

16. A tariff is best defined as:

[1]

- ☐ A A government limit on the quantity of goods that may be imported
- ☐ B A tax imposed on imported goods
- ☐ C A complete ban on certain foreign products
- ☐ D A subsidy given to local businesses

17. 'Brain drain' refers to:

[1]

- ☐ A Insufficient funding for education in developing countries
- ☐ B Declining examination results in secondary schools
- ☐ C The emigration of highly skilled and educated workers to wealthier countries
- ☐ D Over-investment in higher education institutions

18. Cultural globalisation is best illustrated by:

[1]

- ☐ A A country increasing its defence spending

- ☐ B The worldwide spread of consumer brands, music, and lifestyle from dominant cultures
- ☐ C Rising military spending in developing nations
- ☐ D A government reducing foreign aid budgets

19. Which of the following is a POSITIVE effect of globalisation?

[1]

- ☐ A Increased cultural homogenisation and loss of local traditions
- ☐ B Greater income inequality between nations
- ☐ C Access to new technologies, capital, and export markets
- ☐ D Increased environmental degradation from industrial activity

20. The International Monetary Fund (IMF) primarily:

[1]

- ☐ A Manages the United Nations budget and peacekeeping operations
- ☐ B Promotes global monetary cooperation and provides financial assistance to countries
- ☐ C Controls international trade rules and tariff negotiations
- ☐ D Builds roads, schools, and hospitals in developing countries

SECTION B — Source-Based Questions [30 marks] Answer ALL questions in this section.

SOURCE A

Mauritius has been widely recognised as one of Africa's most stable and mature democracies. Since gaining independence in 1968, the country has consistently held regular, free, and fair elections under a parliamentary system of government. The Constitution of Mauritius, which serves as the supreme law of the land, enshrines fundamental rights and freedoms including freedom of expression, freedom of conscience, the right to a fair trial, and protection from discrimination on grounds of race, caste, religion, or sex. The National Assembly consists of 62 directly elected members and up to 8 additional seats allocated through the Best Loser System to ensure that minority communities are fairly represented. The Prime Minister, as head of government, is accountable to the National Assembly, which exercises oversight through parliamentary debate, question time, and select committees. The President of Mauritius, appointed by the National Assembly, serves as a constitutional head of state with largely ceremonial functions.

Adapted from: Democracy Index, Mauritius Country Profile, 2024

21.

- (a) Using Source A, what is meant by a 'parliamentary system of government'?

[2]

- (b) Using Source A, identify **TWO** fundamental rights guaranteed by the Mauritian Constitution and explain why each right is important for citizens.

[4]

- (c) Explain the purpose of the Best Loser System in Mauritius. Why is it considered important for democracy?

[4]

SOURCE B

Table: Mauritius — Selected Trade and Globalisation Indicators (2023)

Indicator	Value
Merchandise exports (USD billion)	2.9
Merchandise imports (USD billion)	6.8
Services exports — tourism & finance (USD billion)	3.4
FDI inflows (USD million)	578
Number of TNCs operating in Mauritius	450+
Top merchandise export destination	France (18%)
Main merchandise imports	Petroleum, capital goods, food

Source: Statistics Mauritius / Bank of Mauritius Annual Report, 2023

22.

- (a) Using Source B, calculate the merchandise trade deficit for Mauritius in 2023. Show your working.

[2]

- (b) Using Source B, explain what the data suggests about the importance of the service sector to the Mauritian economy.

[4]

- (c) Identify **TWO** pieces of evidence from Source B that show how Mauritius is integrated into the global economy. Explain each piece of evidence.

[4]

SOURCE C

"Globalisation has created unprecedented opportunities for small economies to integrate into global value chains and access foreign technology, investment, and markets. Countries like Mauritius have successfully diversified their economies — from sugar monoculture to tourism, manufacturing, and financial services — largely because of their openness to the global economy. However, globalisation is not without risks. Many developing nations face challenges such as increased competition from cheaper imports that threaten local industries, greater economic vulnerability to external shocks such as global recessions and pandemics, cultural homogenisation as Western consumer habits spread, and the exodus of skilled workers seeking better opportunities abroad (known as 'brain drain'). Small island developing states (SIDS) are particularly exposed to these risks because of their limited economic size, narrow production base, and heavy dependence on a small number of trading partners. The key challenge for governments is to maximise the benefits of openness while protecting the most vulnerable sectors and workers."

Adapted from: UNDP Report on Globalisation and Small Island Developing States, 2023

23.

- (a) Using Source C, what is meant by 'global value chains'?

[2]

- (b) Using Source C, identify **ONE** benefit and **ONE** challenge of globalisation for developing nations. Explain each using evidence from the source.

[4]

- (c) Using Source C and your own knowledge, suggest **TWO** measures a small island economy like Mauritius can take to reduce its vulnerability to the negative effects of globalisation.

[4]

SECTION C — Structured Essay Questions [30 marks] Answer ALL THREE questions.

- 24. Describe the main features of parliamentary democracy in Mauritius.**

[10]

In your answer, refer to: the role of the National Assembly; the function of the Prime Minister; the electoral system; and the protection of citizens' rights.

- 25. Explain how the separation of powers and the Rule of Law work together to protect citizens and prevent the abuse of power in Mauritius.**

[10]

Refer to specific examples of the executive, legislature, and judiciary in your answer.

26. Discuss how globalisation has changed the economy and society of Mauritius since independence in 1968.

[10]

Your answer should address: economic diversification; the role of TNCs and FDI; social and cultural changes; and the challenges faced.

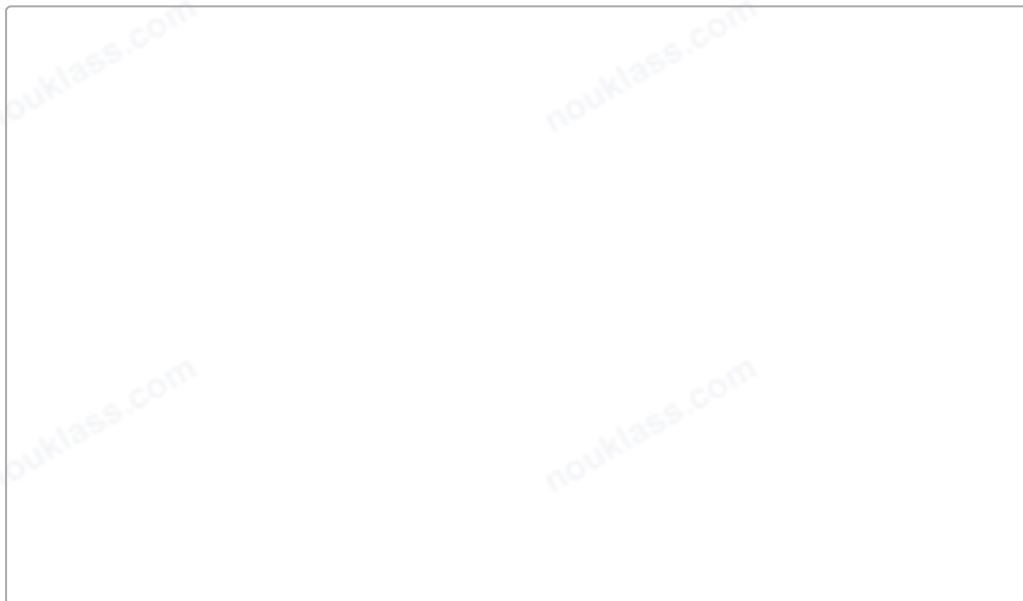
SECTION D — Extended Writing and Evaluation [20 marks] Answer the COMPULSORY question below.

27. "Globalisation brings more benefits than challenges for developing countries like Mauritius."

[20]

Using your knowledge and the evidence in Section B, write a well-organised essay in which you:

- Define globalisation and describe its main features
- Analyse the economic benefits of globalisation for Mauritius
- Analyse the social and cultural challenges of globalisation for Mauritius
- Evaluate whether the benefits outweigh the challenges, with a justified conclusion



Mark Scheme — Paper 1: Governance & Democracy / Globalisation

This mark scheme provides **indicative content**. Credit any well-reasoned response that demonstrates knowledge and understanding. Exact wording is not required. Markers should reward quality of argument, use of evidence, and clarity.

Section A — MCQ Answers

1. B — Constitution 2. C — 1968 3. C — Prime Minister 4. C — Every 5 years 5. B — Proportional communal representation	6. B — Every adult has right to vote 7. C — Executive, legislative, judicial 8. C — Interpreting and applying the law 9. B — Freedom of expression 10. C — Every person accountable under the law
11. C — Growing interconnection of economies/cultures 12. B — Regulate international trade 13. B — Investment from one country into business in another 14. C — Operates in more than one country 15. B — Reducing barriers to trade	16. B — Tax on imported goods 17. C — Emigration of skilled workers 18. B — Spread of consumer brands/lifestyle 19. C — Access to technology and markets 20. B — Promotes monetary cooperation/financial assistance

Q	Indicative Content	Marks
21(a)	A system of government in which the executive (Prime Minister and Cabinet) is drawn from and accountable to the legislature (National Assembly); the government must maintain the confidence of parliament to remain in power.	2
21(b)	Any TWO from: freedom of expression (citizens may speak, write, and communicate freely without state censorship); freedom of conscience / religion (citizens may practise any religion); protection from discrimination (no person may be treated differently on grounds of race, sex, religion); right to a fair trial (accused persons have right to proper legal process). Award 2 marks per right: 1 for identifying, 1 for explaining importance.	4
21(c)	The Best Loser System allocates up to 8 additional National Assembly seats to candidates from under-represented communities after the 62 elected seats are filled. It ensures minority ethnic and religious communities have a voice in government; it prevents any single community from being completely shut out; it maintains social cohesion in a diverse, multi-ethnic society. Award marks for accurate description plus explanation of importance.	4

22(a)	Merchandise trade deficit = Imports – Exports = USD 6.8bn – USD 2.9bn = USD 3.9 billion . Award 1 mark for method, 1 mark for correct answer.	2
22(b)	Services exports (USD 3.4bn) nearly equal merchandise exports (USD 2.9bn), suggesting the service sector is a major contributor to the economy; services help offset the large merchandise trade deficit; this indicates Mauritius has diversified away from goods production towards services such as tourism and financial services.	4
22(c)	Any TWO with explanation: FDI inflows of USD 578m show foreign capital investment; 450+ TNCs show Mauritius hosts many global companies; France as top export destination shows international trade linkages; importing petroleum and capital goods shows dependence on global supply chains. Award 2 marks per point: 1 for identifying from data, 1 for explaining what it shows.	4
23(a)	Networks of interconnected stages of production spread across different countries, in which each country contributes a part of a final product before it reaches the consumer; Mauritius may be part of textile, sugar, or financial value chains.	2
23(b)	<i>Benefit</i> : access to foreign investment and markets allowed Mauritius to diversify from sugar to tourism, manufacturing, and financial services (economic development). <i>Challenge</i> : cheap imports threaten local industries; economic vulnerability to global recessions/pandemics; cultural homogenisation; brain drain. Award 2 marks per point: 1 for identifying, 1 for explaining with source evidence.	4
23(c)	Any TWO from: diversify the economy to avoid dependence on one sector; develop high-skilled workforce to retain talent; negotiate fair trade agreements; invest in innovation and technology to remain competitive; build social safety nets to protect workers displaced by globalisation; join regional trading blocs (SADC, COMESA). Award 2 marks per measure: 1 for naming, 1 for explaining how it reduces vulnerability.	4
24	Band descriptors : 8–10: Detailed, accurate knowledge of at least 3 features with clear analysis; well-organised with examples. 5–7: Good knowledge of 2–3 features; some analysis; reasonable organisation. 2–4: Basic knowledge; limited analysis; some errors. 0–1: Very limited or largely inaccurate. <i>Content</i> : National Assembly (62 elected + BLS seats; lawmaking role; question time); PM heads government, leads Cabinet, accountable to Assembly; first-past-the-post elections with BLS; Constitution protects fundamental rights; judiciary independent.	10
25	<i>Content</i> : Executive (PM/Cabinet) implements law but cannot make law alone; Legislature (National Assembly) makes law but cannot execute independently; Judiciary interprets law and can strike down unconstitutional acts. Rule of Law: all, including government, subject to law; independent courts uphold rights. Checks and balances prevent concentration of power. Award marks for understanding of each branch plus explanation of how the rule of law links to protection of citizens.	10
26	<i>Content</i> : Economic diversification from sugar monoculture (1968) to EPZ manufacturing (1970s–80s), tourism (1980s onwards), financial services (1990s), ICT/technology (2000s);	10

	FDI and TNCs created jobs; remittances; cultural changes — spread of Western brands, tourism changed cultural landscape; challenges — brain drain, income inequality, vulnerability to global recessions (2008, COVID-19 2020). Strong answers will show a chronological progression and balance of positive and negative.	
27	Extended essay — 20 marks. Level 4 (16–20): Sustained, balanced argument with detailed analysis; definition of globalisation; multiple economic benefits (FDI, markets, diversification, employment); multiple challenges (brain drain, inequality, cultural change, vulnerability); well-supported conclusion. Level 3 (11–15): Good argument, mostly balanced; some analysis; reasonable use of evidence. Level 2 (6–10): Some relevant points; limited analysis; may be one-sided. Level 1 (1–5): Very limited; largely descriptive or irrelevant. Level 0: No credit.	20